

IG Focus Hub

Instagram without the doomscrolling

Product specification for a focused Instagram companion app

3-account inbox • notifications • sent-Reels-only viewer • publishing • business tools

Core principle

Keep the communication and business tools.

Remove feeds, Explore, infinite Reels, and recommendation loops.

Inbox

Create

Business

Notifications

Prepared as a development-ready feature and design brief

1. Product vision

IG Focus Hub is a focused Instagram companion for people who still need Instagram for communication and business, but do not want the feed, Explore, or infinite Reels experience.

The product should feel familiar to an Instagram user, but every screen has a purpose: **communicate, publish, manage, leave.**

KEEP	REMOVE
DMs and customer conversations Sent Reels and shared posts Push notifications Publishing and scheduling Comments and business tools Insights and content library	Home feed Explore Reels browsing Stories browsing Suggested posts/accounts Infinite recommendation loops

Primary users

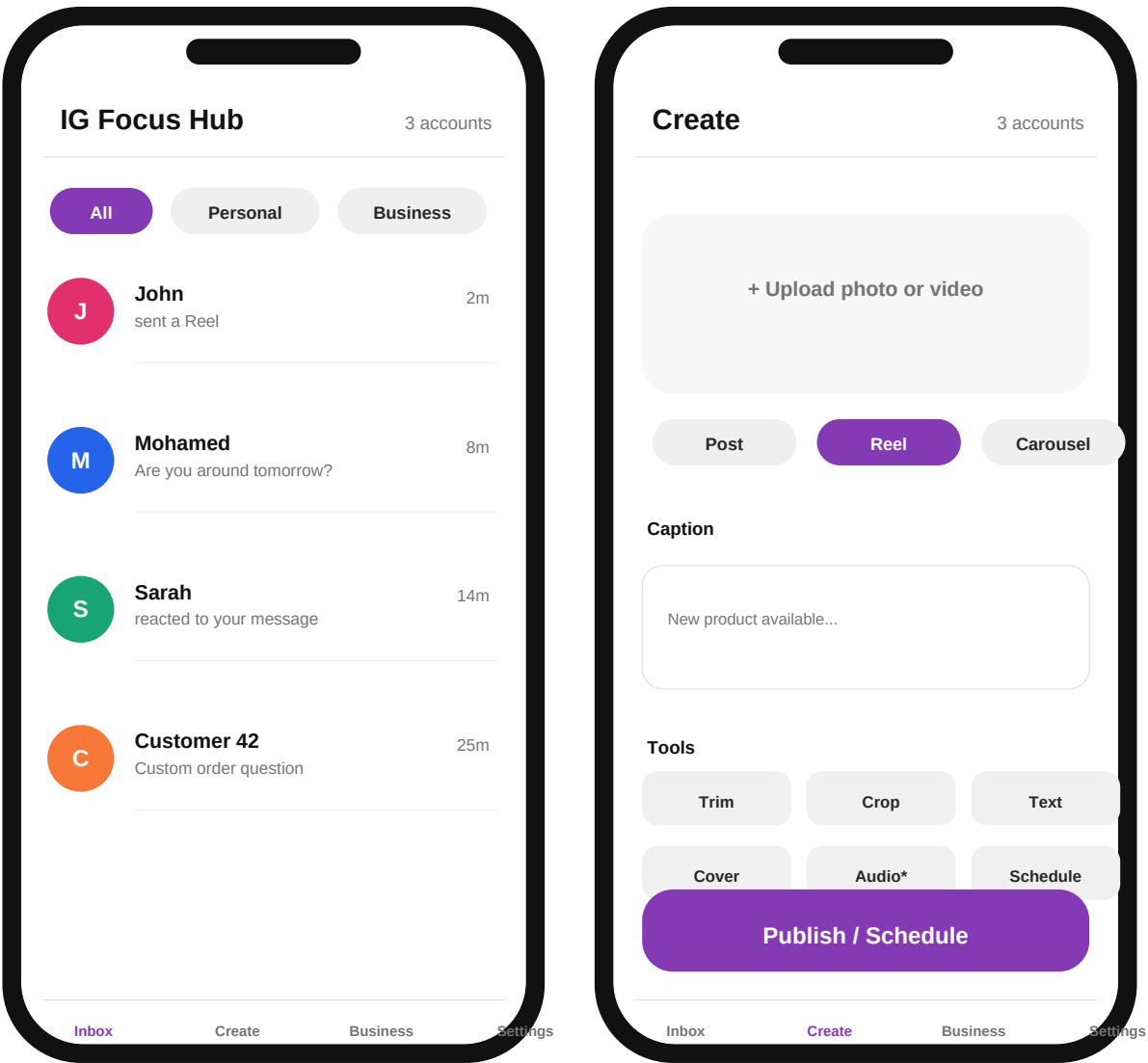
- The owner of three Instagram accounts who wants one combined inbox.
- A small-business owner who needs Instagram to post, answer customers, and monitor comments.
- Anyone who wants the useful parts of Instagram while deliberately removing doomscrolling triggers.

2. Navigation and experience

The app should use a simple bottom navigation with only productive destinations. The visual design can borrow familiar social-app patterns - rounded cards, profile circles, gradient accents, white space - while remaining its own focused product.

Inbox	Create	Business	Content	Settings
Unified DMs	Publish	Comments + stats	Drafts + scheduled	Accounts + alerts

Sample mobile direction



Inbox and Create concepts. The final interface should remain intentionally sparse: no route from these screens into a recommendation feed.

3. Unified messaging hub

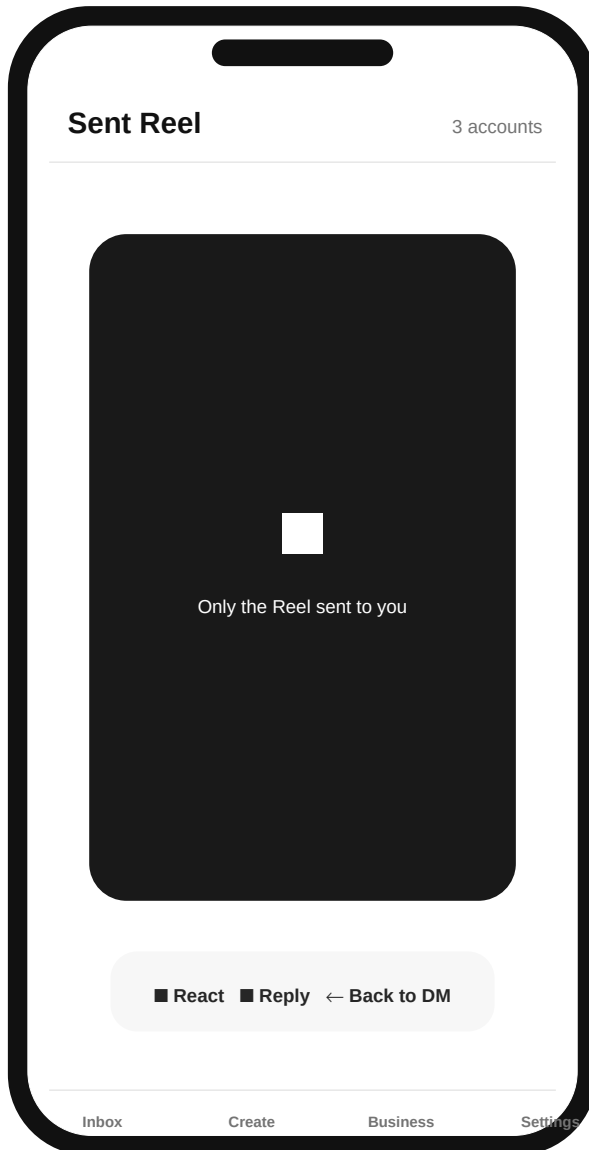
Three-account unified inbox	CORE
Combine conversations from all connected professional Instagram accounts, with clear account labels and optional account-specific filtering.	
Conversation view	CORE
Read and reply to one-to-one DMs, see media and shared content, and keep the sender/account identity visible.	
Reactions	CORE
React to supported message events, including a Reel shared as a DM message, and display reactions received from the other person.	
Search and organization	CORE
Search conversations, favorite important threads, mute locally, add private labels, and mark conversations as needing attention.	
Saved replies	CORE
Create reusable responses for pricing, order updates, shipping, custom-product requirements, FAQs, and customer service.	
Customer notes	CORE
Attach private notes and lightweight CRM labels such as Lead, Customer, Order Issue, Waiting, or Follow-up.	

Important messaging constraints

Meta API rules may limit group DMs, starting conversations with arbitrary users, or certain message types. The product should display unsupported actions clearly instead of pretending they are available.

4. Sent-Reels-only viewer

The app should support the social part of Reels without recreating the addictive Reel feed. If someone sends a Reel in a DM, the user can open **that Reel only**.



Viewer behavior

- Open only from a DM message.
- Play the selected shared Reel.
- React to the DM message.
- Reply to the Reel in the conversation.
- Return directly to the chat.
- No swipe-up next Reel.
- No recommendations.
- No Explore route.

Fallback: if Meta does not provide direct playable media, open the exact shared Instagram URL in a tightly controlled browser view and return to the DM afterward.

5. Notifications

Notifications are a core feature because they let the user respond without opening Instagram itself.

New DMs Push alert with sender, account, and preview.	CORE
Sent Reel alerts Example: "John sent you a Reel" with direct open to that conversation.	CORE
Reaction alerts Notify when someone reacts to a supported message.	CORE
Per-account controls Enable, disable, or customize alerts independently for all three accounts.	CORE
Priority contacts Star people whose messages should always surface prominently.	CORE
Quiet hours Suppress normal alerts during selected hours while optionally allowing priority contacts.	CORE
Badge counts Show combined unread count on the PWA icon where supported by iOS.	CORE
Deep links Tap a notification and land directly in the correct account and conversation.	CORE

6. Three-account management

Capability	What the app can do	Status
Unified account switcher	Fast switch among all connected accounts.	Ready
All-in-one inbox	Combined conversations with account badges.	Ready
Per-account unread count	Show unread conversations/messages separately.	Custom
Reply safety	Always show the sending account before a reply is sent.	Custom
Per-account notification rules	Different alert settings for each account.	Custom
Per-account publishing	Choose the publishing account from Create.	Ready
Connect/disconnect	Manage authorization for each Instagram account.	Ready

Recommended visual identity

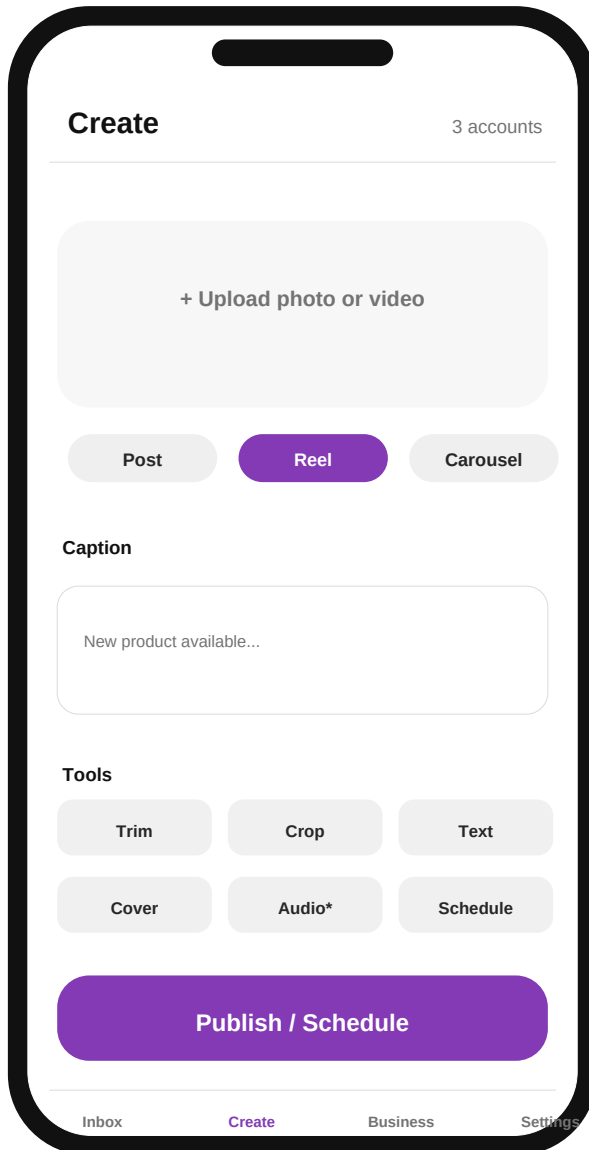
Give each Instagram account a persistent accent color, avatar, and short account label. The selected sending account should appear immediately above the message composer and the final Publish button.

7. Create and publish

Photo posts	CORE
Upload an image, write a caption, preview, and publish to the selected account.	
Video posts and Reels	CORE
Upload a finished video and publish it as supported content.	
Carousel posts	CORE
Create a multi-item image/video carousel within Meta publishing limits.	
Captions and hashtags	CORE
Write, save, edit, and reuse captions before publishing.	
Cover selection	CORE
Choose or prepare a cover image for video/Reel content where supported.	
Drafts	CORE
Save unfinished content inside IG Focus Hub instead of Instagram.	
Scheduling	CORE
Store approved content in our backend and publish at the selected future time.	
Post preview	CORE
Show an Instagram-like preview without exposing the Home feed.	

7A. Creation studio

The editing experience should cover the practical tools needed to prepare business content without opening Instagram itself.



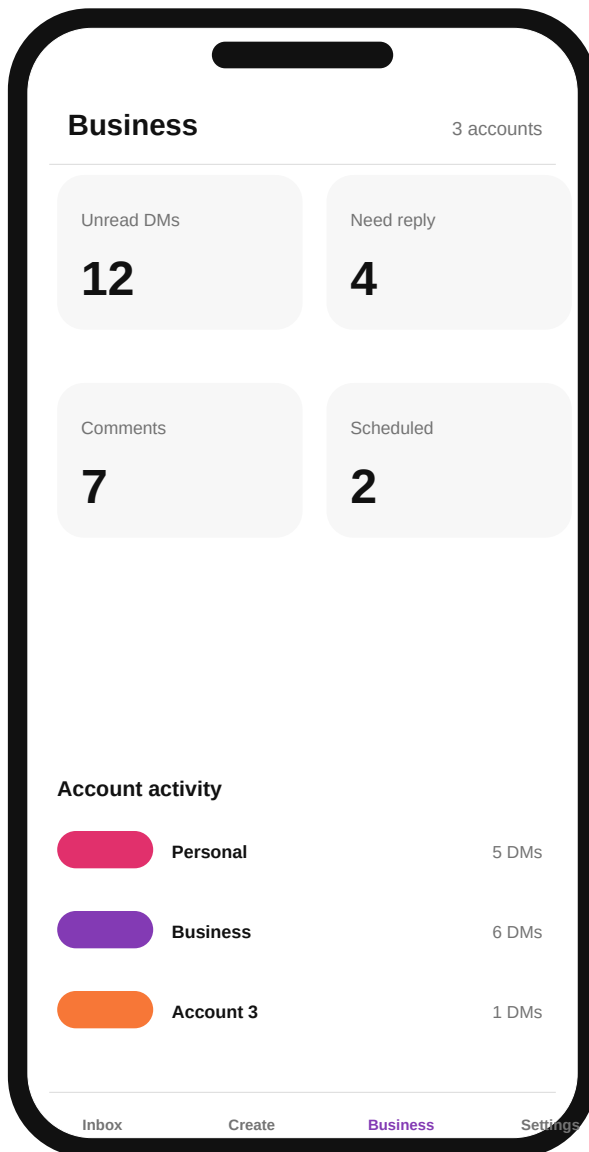
Built-in editing tools

- Trim start/end of video
- Crop and resize to common Instagram aspect ratios
- Rotate media
- Add simple text overlays
- Adjust original video volume
- Choose or create a cover
- Basic image adjustments
- Attach your own licensed/original audio before upload

Music note: Do not assume the complete Instagram licensed-music picker is available to third-party apps. Treat Instagram-catalog music as Meta-dependent. The reliable path is publishing media that already contains audio the user has the rights to use.

8. Business tools

Comments hub	CORE
View comments on owned posts/Reels, reply where supported, and surface unanswered comments.	
Mentions	CORE
Surface supported account mentions in a focused activity view.	
Business dashboard	CORE
Unread DMs, conversations needing reply, new comments, and scheduled content at a glance.	
Content performance	CORE
Show supported insights returned by Meta for professional accounts and owned media.	
Content library	CORE
Published, Drafts, and Scheduled tabs with account, date, caption, and basic metrics.	
Customer workflow	CUSTOM
Private tags such as Lead, Customer, Quote Sent, Waiting for Customer, Order Issue, and Completed.	
Saved responses	CUSTOM
One-tap insertion for common customer-service and sales replies.	
Order integration - future	CUSTOM
Optionally connect Instagram conversations to orders from an external store or admin system later.	



Dashboard philosophy

The Business screen should answer four questions immediately:

1. Who needs a reply?
2. What needs moderation?
3. What content is scheduled?
4. How is owned content performing?

It should never turn into another discovery feed.

9. Anti-doomscrolling design rules

These are product requirements, not optional preferences. They keep the app aligned with its purpose.

No home feed	CORE
There is no screen that displays posts from followed accounts.	
No Explore	CORE
No discovery grid, trending recommendations, or suggested accounts.	
No Reel browser	CORE
Reels are viewable only when intentionally opened from a DM or owned-content library.	
No swipe-next behavior	CORE
Finishing a Reel returns to the conversation or previous screen.	
No algorithmic recommendations	CORE
The backend should not fetch or construct engagement-based content recommendations.	
Finite lists	CORE
Inbox, comments, and content lists use clear stopping points/pagination rather than endless entertainment scrolling.	
Action-first home screen	CORE
Opening the app lands on unread conversations, pending replies, or business tasks - never content consumption.	
Exit after task completion	CORE
After sending a reply or publishing, the UI should naturally route back to a neutral dashboard rather than suggesting more content.	

10. Feature availability matrix

Capability	What the app can do	Status
1:1 DMs	Read/reply through supported Instagram messaging APIs.	Ready
DM reactions	React/unreact where supported.	Ready
Sent Reel message	Display shared content and open the exact Reel.	Meta-dependent
Direct Reel playback	Use direct media URL only when Meta exposes it.	Meta-dependent
Group DMs	Do not promise support.	Not available
Arbitrary new DMs	May be restricted by Meta conversation rules.	Meta-dependent
Push notifications	PWA Web Push + backend webhook events.	Custom
Three accounts	Separate tokens/account identities in one hub.	Custom
Publish photo/video	Publish owned media through Meta where authorized.	Ready
Publish Reels	Publish supported Reel media.	Ready
Carousel publishing	Supported within platform limits.	Ready
Scheduling	Our server schedules the publish call.	Custom
Full IG music picker	Do not promise Instagram's entire licensed catalog.	Not available
Basic editing	Trim/crop/text/cover/volume implemented by us.	Custom
Comments	Read/reply/manage where supported.	Ready
Insights	Display metrics Meta exposes for professional accounts.	Ready
Stories	Support depends on account/authentication/API route.	Meta-dependent
Ads manager	Out of scope for the initial app.	Not available

11. Technical architecture

Recommended implementation: installable PWA frontend + secure backend + database + Meta authentication/webhooks.

Your 3 IG Accounts	Meta Platform	IG Focus Hub Backend	PWA on iPhone
Professional accounts	OAuth / permissions Messaging Publishing Webhooks	Tokens DB Scheduler Push service	Inbox Create Business Notifications

Recommended stack

- Frontend: React / Next.js PWA optimized for iPhone Safari and desktop browsers.
- Backend: Node.js/TypeScript or another secure web backend.
- Database: PostgreSQL or MongoDB for app-specific metadata, drafts, labels, and scheduled jobs.
- Authentication: user login for IG Focus Hub plus Meta OAuth for each connected Instagram account.
- Webhooks: receive supported Instagram messaging/comment events.
- Push: Web Push for the installed iPhone PWA.
- Scheduler: durable job queue for scheduled publishing and retries.
- Media storage: secure object storage for drafts and scheduled assets; avoid retaining unnecessary Instagram media.

Security requirements

- Never store Instagram passwords.
- Encrypt access/refresh tokens at rest.
- Use HTTPS only.
- Use CSRF/state protection during OAuth.
- Log out/disconnect should revoke or delete stored credentials where possible.
- Keep business notes and customer metadata private to the app owner.

12. Development roadmap

Phase 1 - Core Focus App	CORE
PWA shell, user login, connect up to 3 Instagram professional accounts, unified inbox, account filters, reply, sent-media handling, notifications, basic settings.	
Phase 2 - Creation	PLANNED
Photo/video/Reel publishing, captions, drafts, account selection, basic media editor, preview, scheduled publishing.	
Phase 3 - Business	PLANNED
Comments hub, saved replies, private customer labels/notes, content library, supported insights, business dashboard.	
Phase 4 - Refinement	PLANNED
Priority contacts, advanced notification rules, content templates, deeper analytics, optional commerce/order integrations, reliability and audit tools.	

Definition of success

The user can remove the Instagram app from their normal routine and still handle the communication and business tasks that matter: respond to people, view what friends send, publish content, manage comments, receive alerts, and monitor the business - without being offered an infinite feed.

13. Final product summary

Messaging	CORE
3-account unified inbox, replies, reactions, shared content, saved replies, customer labels.	
Reels	CORE
Only Reels intentionally sent to the user or owned by the user; no Reel browsing.	
Notifications	CORE
Push alerts, badges, deep links, quiet hours, priority people, per-account settings.	
Publishing	CORE
Photo, video, Reel, carousel, caption, drafts, previews, scheduling, basic editing.	
Business	CORE
Comments, supported mentions, content library, insights, customer workflow and dashboard.	
Anti-scroll	CORE
No Home feed, Explore, Stories browsing, suggested posts, trending discovery, or infinite recommendation loops.	
Distribution	CORE
Installable PWA from Safari - no public App Store release required for the core experience.	
Account model	CORE
Built around professional Instagram accounts and Meta-approved permissions.	

Product statement

IG Focus Hub should make Instagram useful again by separating the tools you need from the attention loops you do not.